

School of Interdisciplinary Studies

Education (BA) with 7-12 Social Studies (Geography Concentration)

UT Dallas offers rigorous university-based teacher certification curricula and enjoys an outstanding reputation for producing excellent teachers.

At UT Dallas, coursework and field experiences leading to teacher certification may be accomplished through either the Teacher Development Center (TDC) program in the School of Interdisciplinary Studies (972-883-2730) or through UTeach Dallas program in the School of Natural Sciences and Mathematics (NS&M) (972-883-2496).

UT Dallas School of Interdisciplinary Studies offers both a Bachelor of Arts in Education degree (BAED) and a Bachelor of Science in Education degree (BSED). Each degree emphasizes a broad understanding and wide perspective of the field of education. Becoming a teacher takes preparation and planning. To ensure the highest professional standards, the state of Texas and UT Dallas require students to pass a series of rigorous courses, complete extensive fieldwork and demonstrate their knowledge of content and educational expertise on state licensure exams to become fully certified as a highly qualified teacher in Texas. The TDC at UT Dallas offers all the preparation courses required for teacher certification, including practical classes in curriculum and instruction, educational technology, and classroom management. The TDC interfaces and engages with all academic schools at UT Dallas, as well as many area school districts, to assist students as they progress through the teacher certification program. The Teacher Development Center at UT Dallas is fully accredited by the Texas Education Agency.

All BAED and BSED students are required to select a certification focus before their junior year.

Bachelor of Arts in Education with 7-12 Social Studies (Geography Concentration)

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Erin A. Smith

Professor of Instruction: Tonja Wissinger

Associate Professors of Instruction: Kathleen Byrnes, Patricia A. Leek

Assistant Professors of Instruction: Leah Goudy, Kyle Hammonds, Ruth Johnson, June Jones, Marc Lusk, Michele McNeel, Azadeh Stark, Chelsea Taylor, Larissa Werhnyak

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

[MATH 1314](#) College Algebra

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

[GEOS 1303](#) Physical Geology¹

[GEOS 1304](#) History of Earth and Life²

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)³

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

[GEOG 2303](#) World Regional Geography

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses. (see advisor)³

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics

[GEOG 2302](#) The Global Environment

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses. (see advisor)³

II. Major Requirements: 61 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[BIS 1100](#) Interdisciplinary Studies First Year Experience

Major Related Courses (18 semester credit hours)

[AMS 4305](#) World History for Teachers

[BIS 3320](#) The Nature of Intellectual Inquiry

[ED 4694](#) Student Teaching Secondary

or [ED 4394](#) Residency 1- Secondary

and [ED 4395](#) Residency 2- Secondary

3 semester credit hour lower- or upper-level [ISIS](#) course

3 semester credit hour lower- or upper-level [ISIS](#) or [ISNS](#) course

Foundation I: Economic, Political and Policy Sciences (12 semester credit hours)

[ECON 2302](#) Principles of Microeconomics⁴

[GEOG 3359](#) Human Migration and Mobility

[GEOG 3370](#) The Global Economy

[GEOG 3372](#) Population and Development

Foundation II: Education (12 semester credit hours)

[ED 3314](#) The American Public School

[ED 3339](#) Educational Psychology for Teachers

or [PSY 3339](#) Educational Psychology

[ED 4353](#) Reading in Secondary Content

[ED 4361](#) Classroom Management Secondary

Teaching Techniques (18 semester credit hours)

[AMS 4300](#) Oral and Written Communication for the Classroom

[ED 3382](#) Curriculum and Instruction in Social Studies

[ED 4372](#) Educational Technology

[GEOS 2310](#) Environmental Geosciences⁴

[HIST 2301](#) History of Texas⁴

3 semester credit hour upper-level [GEOG](#) course

III. Certification Requirements and Recommendations: 17 semester credit hours

[BIS 4306](#) Strategies for Diversity in Education

[ED 4351](#) ESL for K-12 Teachers

[ED 4301](#) Exceptional Populations

Guided Electives

8 semester credit hours of lower- or upper-level courses (see advisor)³

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

1. Requires enrollment in corequisite lab course GEOS 1103. Lab semester credit hours to be counted in Guided Electives.
2. Requires enrollment in corequisite lab course GEOS 1104. Lab semester credit hours to be counted in Guided Electives.
3. Students are strongly encouraged to take core courses that are closely related to their foundations, concentrations, and career goals.
4. A required Major course that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours

may be counted in Core Curriculum.

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